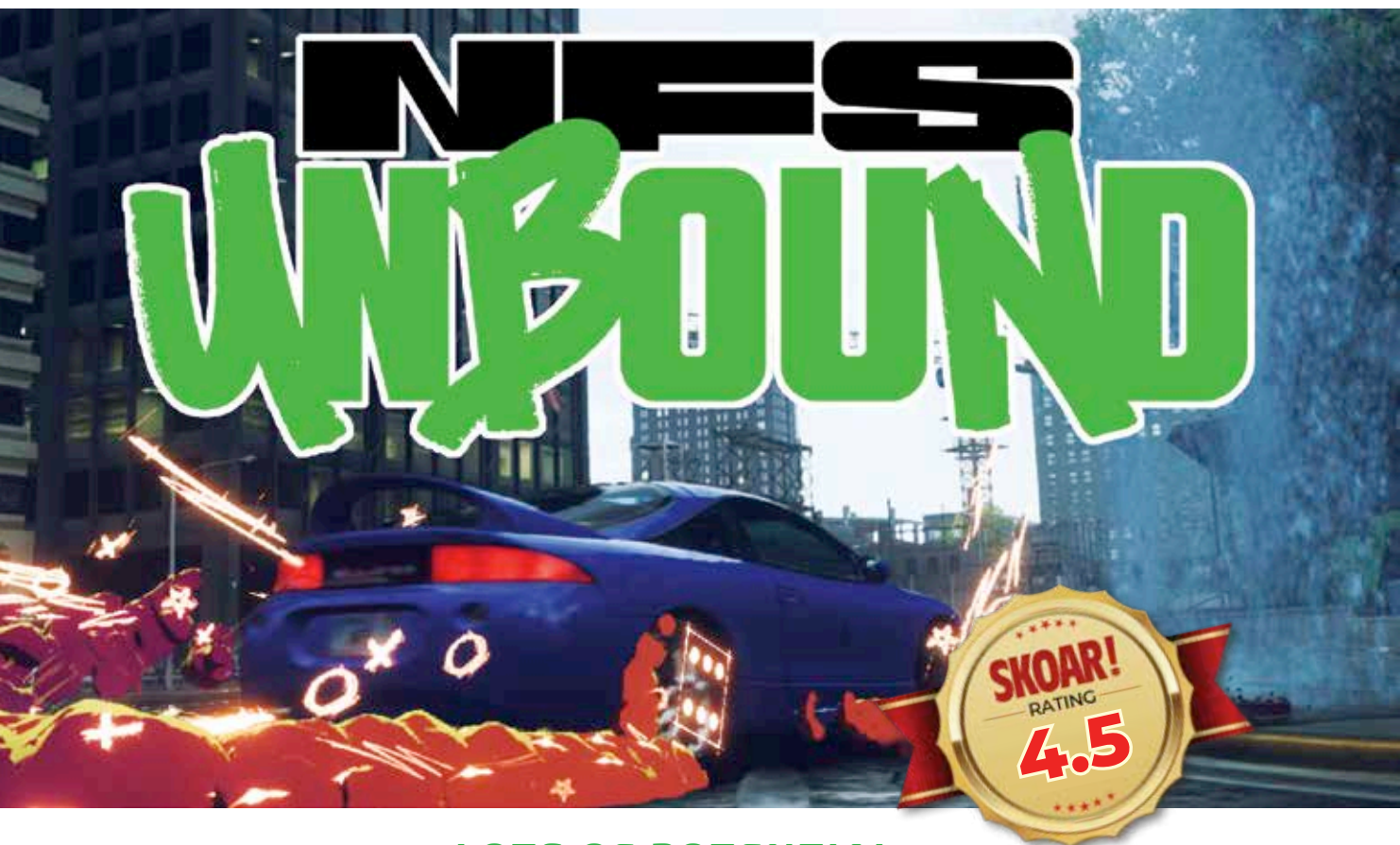




LOTS OF POTENTIAL, BUT FIZZLES OUT BEFORE THE END.

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It has been quite a while since a Need for Speed game generated so much hype. From the trailers and promotional videos,

Unbound seemed to be a nice and creative departure from previous NFS games or any other racing game in the market today. At least visually, that is. After a long time, we felt the need... the need for speed.

When we got our hands on the game though, it was a weird mix of emotions as some aspects of the game had us swooning while others simply left us scratching our heads.

Visuals

So, let's talk a bit about what can be called the most character-defining aspect of Need for Speed Unbound. The visuals. It is absolutely unique in

the way it looks – it's creative, it's new, and needless to say, it provided quite the breath of fresh air that has been missing from the NFS franchise and the racing genre as a whole.

The developer, Criterion Games has gone with a weird mix of photo-realism and an anime-esque art style. On paper, this should not work at all; but somehow Unbound makes that style its own and we can't get enough of it. Most of the game has the usual photo-realistic look that we see in most racing games and looks great as well. The cars and the environment follow this art style.

The character models though are anything but photo-realistic. Think 3D CGI anime meets the real world. And as much as you might think that highly stylised art styles would not

interact well with the world they have been put into, oh boy are you in for a pleasant surprise.

There are other comic and anime-inspired touches thrown in as well like the smoke effects that appear out of the tyres while drifting and other graffiti that shows up while doing tricks like jumps.

Story

Sooooo... there is a story. We're pretty sure there's a story... So here's the gist of it. Two friends build an exotic car together. One of the friends betrays the other and steals the car along with all the other cars in their repair shop. A couple of years later the thief resurfaces and with all the money made with the stolen cars, restarts illegal racing with high